

ALMILA BAŞAK

PhD Candidate, Political Science

CONTACT INFORMATION	Department of Political Science Maxwell School of Citizenship and Public Affairs Syracuse University 024 Eggers Hall, Syracuse, New York 13244	@ abasak@syr.edu ☎ +1 315.560.8204 https://almilabasak.github.io
EDUCATION	Doctor of Philosophy — Political Science Syracuse University, United States of America	2021 – 2027 (Expected)
	- Fields: Comparative Politics (Major), Law and Courts (Minor) - Dissertation: <i>Varieties of Right-Wing Populism in Europe</i> - Committee: Dr. Seth K. Jolly (Chair), Dr. Margarita Estevez-Abe, Dr. Jessie Trudeau	
	Master of Arts — Political Science Syracuse University, United States of America	2021 – 2023
	Bachelor of Science — Political Science and Public Administration Middle East Technical University, Turkey Minor: Economics	2014 – 2019
ACADEMIC AFFILIATIONS	Graduate Research Associate Moynihan Institute of Global Affairs, Maxwell School Center for European Studies Middle Eastern Studies Program	2024 – Present 2023 – Present
	Teaching Associate Future Professoriate Program, Syracuse University	2023 – 2026

Research

RESEARCH INTERESTS	Subfields: Comparative Politics, Political Behavior, Political Economy Specific Interests: Political Parties, Populism, Welfare Politics, Social Policy, European Politics, Turkish Politics Methodological Interests: Survey Research, Expert Surveys, Mixed-Method Approach, Text-as-Data
WORKING PAPERS	[1] Welfare Promises of Right-Wing Populist Parties: Whom to Attract and How to Allocate? [2] The electoral returns to vote buying: Evidence from Brazil (with Dr. Trudeau) [3] Dissatisfied Voters or Alienated Abstainers? Abstention and Voter-Parliament Incongruence (with Dr. Jolly)
IN PROGRESS	[1] Social Policy Preferences in Populist Welfare Regimes: Evidence from Turkey [2] Understanding the Gender Gap in Party Preferences: The role of welfare regime inclusiveness [3] Measuring Issue Salience for Party Manifestos using LLMs: Alternative to Hand-coding? [4] Preferences of Low-income voters and the Left-Wing Parties

RESEARCH	Graduate Research Assistant, Dr. Jessie Trudeau	Spring 2026
APPOINTMENTS	Graduate Research Assistant, Dr. Jessie Trudeau	Spring 2025
	Graduate Research Assistant, Dr. Jessie Trudeau	2023-2024
	Global Free Speech Repository Research Assistant, Dr. Thomas Keck	2022 – 2023
CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS	[15] “The electoral returns to vote buying: Evidence from Brazil”, presented at the <i>Electoral Integrity Project</i> Conference with Dr. Jessie Trudeau.	June 2026
	[14] “Welfare Promises of Right-Wing Populist Parties:Whom to Attract and How to Allocate”, presented at the <i>European Political Science Society</i> Conference.	June 2026
	[13] “Welfare Promises of Right-Wing Populist Parties:Whom to Attract and How to Allocate?”, presented at the <i>APSA Dissertation Workshop on European Politics</i> .	June 2026
	[12] “Welfare Promises of Right-Wing Populist Parties:Whom to Attract and How to Allocate?”, presented at the <i>Midwest Political Science Association</i> Conference.	April 2026
	[11] “The electoral returns to vote buying: Evidence from Brazil”, presented at the <i>Midwest Political Science Association</i> Conference with Dr. Jessie Trudeau.	April 2026
	[10] “The electoral returns to vote buying: Evidence from Brazil”, presented at the <i>Political Science Research Workshop</i> at Syracuse University.	April 2026
	[9] “Welfare Promises of Right-Wing Populist Parties:Whom to Attract and How to Allocate?”, presented at the <i>European Politics Workshop</i> at Syracuse University.	March 2026
	[8] “Dissatisfied Voters or Alienated Abstainers? Abstention and Voter-Parliament Incongruence”, presented at the <i>European Union Studies Association</i> Conference with Dr. Seth Jolly.	May 2025
	[7] “Welfare Platforms of Populist Entrepreneurs”, presented at the <i>Political Science Research Workshop</i> at Syracuse University.	March 2025
	[6] “Welfare Platforms of Populist Entrepreneurs” presented at the <i>European Politics Workshop</i> at Syracuse University.	March 2025
	[5] “Welfare State Policies: Window for Party Politics?”, presented at the <i>American Political Science Association</i> Conference.	September 2024
	[4] “Welfare State Policies: Window for Party Politics?”, presented at the <i>Political Science Research Workshop</i> at Syracuse University.	April 2024
	[3] “Understanding the Gender Gap in Party Preferences: The Case of the AKP era in Turkey”, presented at the <i>European Politics Workshop</i> at Syracuse University.	March 2025
	[2] “Understanding the Unnatural Voting: The Case of AKP era”, presented at the Annual Meeting of <i>Northeastern Political Science Association</i> .	November 2022

[1] “Understanding the Unnatural Voting: The Case of AKP era”,
presented at the *Political Science Research Workshop* at
Syracuse University.

September 2022

SKILLS

Software: R, R Studio, ArcGIS Pro, QGIS, MAXQDA, Git

Document Preparation Systems: L^AT_EX, R Markdown, Microsoft Office Suite

Teaching

INSTRUCTOR OF	MAX 132 Global Community (co-instructor)	Fall 2026
RECORD	PSC 388 Globalization and the Rise of Populism	May 2024
TEACHING	PSC 123 Comparative Government and Politics,	Fall 2025
ASSISTANT	<i>Prof Margarita Estevez-Abe</i>	
	Role: Section Leader	
	PSC 123 Comparative Government and Politics,	Fall 2024
	<i>Prof Margarita Estevez-Abe</i>	
	Role: Section Leader	

Grants, Awards, and Honors

GRANTS	APSA Travel Grant	2026
	<i>American Political Science Association</i>	
	Summer Dissertation Fellowship	2026
	<i>Graduate School, Syracuse University</i>	
	Professional, Academic and Creative Work Travel Grant	2026
	<i>Graduate School, Syracuse University</i>	
	Research Assistantship Fellowship	Spring 2026
	<i>Political Science Department, Syracuse University</i>	
	Roscoe Martin Fund for Dissertation and Thesis Research	2025
	<i>Maxwell School of Citizenship and Public Affairs, Syracuse University</i>	
	Goekjian/Center for European Studies Research Grant	2025
	<i>Moynihan Institute of Global Affairs, Syracuse University</i>	
	Research Assistantship Fellowship	Spring 2025
	<i>Political Science Department, Syracuse University</i>	
	Professional, Academic and Creative Work Travel Grant	2024
	<i>Graduate Student Organization, Syracuse University</i>	
	Professional, Academic and Creative Work Travel Grant	2023
	<i>Graduate Student Organization, Syracuse University</i>	
	Fulbright PhD Scholarship	2022-23
	Fulbright PhD Scholarship	2021-22
AWARDS	The Peter Mair Memorial Award	2026
	<i>American Political Science Association</i>	
	<i>European Politics and Society Section</i>	
	Virginia Gray Graduate Student Research Award	2026
	<i>American Political Science Association</i>	
	<i>Political Organizations and Parties Section</i>	

The Ketcham Award	2026
<i>For students whose work exhibits a commitment to open and just public life</i>	
<i>Political Science Department, Syracuse University</i>	
Certificate in University Teaching	2026
<i>The Future Professoriate Program, Syracuse University</i>	
Outstanding Teaching Assistant Award	2026
<i>Graduate School, Syracuse University</i>	
Koff Award	2025
<i>The best graduate student paper written each year on comparative politics</i>	
<i>Political Science Department, Syracuse University</i>	
Young Scholar Prize	2023
<i>For the paper” Social Policy and the Gender Gap in Party Preferences: The Case of the AKP era in Turkey”</i>	
<i>Middle East Studies Program, Syracuse University</i>	

HONORS	1st-ranked student, Department of Political Science and Public Administration, Middle East Technical University	June 2019
	3rd-ranked student, Middle East Technical University (<i>university-wide</i>)	June 2019

Service

TO THE INSTITUTION	– Co-President , Political Science Graduate Student Association.	2023-2024
	– Pre-Comprehensive Exams Student Representative , Political Science Graduate Student Association.	2022-2023
	– Political Science Department Representative , Syracuse University Graduate Student Organization, Graduate Pandemic Committee member	2021-2022
TO THE DISCIPLINE	Discussant , <i>Dissertation workshop on European Politics</i> , APSA	June 2026
	Panelist , <i>Independent Teaching as a Graduate Student</i> organized by Future Professoriate Program	October 2025
	Co-organizer , <i>Future Professoriate Program seminar: "How to present at a conference?"</i> at Political Science Research Workshop, Syracuse University	October 2024
	Organizer , <i>Geocoding Workshop with Dr Trudeau</i> for Political Science Graduate Students.	October 2024
	Co-organizer , <i>Future Professoriate Program seminar: "Predocs, Postdocs, and Fellowships: What You Need to Know"</i> at Political Science Research Workshop, Syracuse University.	December 2023
PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS	European Political Science Society	2026 – Present
	Midwest Political Science Association	2026 – Present
	European Union Studies Association	2025 – Present
	American Political Science Association	2024 – Present